THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

MONDAY, OCTOBER 19, 2026

THE WEEKEND PICTURE

Shares for the public, a Roadster under fire, and code nobody types

Anthropic said Sunday it will put 5% of its shares into a new public benefit fund that can grow with the company's value. Within hours Elon Musk answered that shares should go "directly to the public," and before dawn Monday he pledged one of his SpaceX shares to every child in America next year. Musk also kept promoting the thruster-equipped Roadster Tesla showed Thursday, promising Formula 1 lap records and Grand Canyon jumps, while Yann LeCun ran the compressed-air numbers and called it a stunt.

Alexandr Wang thanked the Meta team behind the Muse models, Nvidia open-sourced its ASPIRE robot-skills framework, and Satya Nadella pointed to a Nature paper on two-to-six-week weather forecasts. François Chollet, Aaron Levie and Tim Sweeney argued over what happens when agents write nearly all the code. Twenty-six of the 46 builders posted; Musk posted 120 times.

I · SHARES FOR THE PUBLIC

Anthropic seeds a fund; Musk promises every kid a SpaceX share

A 5% stake that can grow with valuation, a reply from Musk the same afternoon, and a pledge posted before dawn Monday.

5%	~20%	1 share
Anthropic shares committed to its new fund, subject to stockholder approval	Share of Anthropic now dedicated to the public good, counting founder and employee pledges	Per American child, Musk's pledge for next year

Anthropic's fund announced Sunday

In its announcement, Anthropic said the Anthropic Public Benefit Fund will be a wholly owned LLC rather than a 501(c)(3), starting with 5% of the company's shares and adding up to 2% more, at the board's discretion, for every 50% rise in value above a set baseline. The fund could make "large donations to traditional nonprofits or direct distributions to specific populations," with AI's effect on the labor market named as one target, and none of its Anthropic equity may be used for lobbying or political giving. Counting the co-founders' 80% equity pledge and an employee match, roughly 20% of the company is now committed. Bloomberg reported the move comes as Anthropic prepares for what could be one of the largest initial public offerings (IPOs) ever.

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, SpaceX and Tesla

Replying to Anthropic's post at 4:16pm EDT Sunday, Musk wrote "I recommend giving the shares directly to the public," then added at 8:39pm, "This is what I will be doing." At 3:52am EDT Monday came the pledge:

> *"Next year, I will give one of my SpaceX shares to every kid in America. This will be the first of many."*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

The post passed 220,000 likes within hours. Bloomberg and the BBC noted that no mechanism or eligibility rules have been given. When one reply suggested routing the gift through Invest America accounts, Musk answered "Yes"; to another calling it the beginning of universal basic income, he corrected, "*universal high income." The idea has a company precedent: in July SpaceX president Gwynne Shotwell and her husband gave one SpaceX share to each of more than two million children's Trump Accounts, The Hill reported.

Palmer Luckey @PalmerLuckey · founder, Anduril

Luckey pushed back on Anthropic's framing directly under Musk's reply:

> *"The problem is that their definition of "public good" is helping everyone else, not the American public. If they would commit to helping America and Americans, that would be one thing, but this reeks of USAID 2.0, just another way to funnel billions out of our own economy."*
>
> PALMER LUCKEY · @PALMERLUCKEY · POST

QUICK HIT

Elon Musk on investor Chamath Palihapitiya's view that Anthropic needs to raise at least $200 billion: "Sometimes I wonder how many dollars there are in the world, because super intelligence seems to want them all."

II · THE ROADSTER ARGUMENT

Lap records, canyon jumps and a physics lesson

Musk spent the weekend promising more from the thruster car Tesla showed Thursday. Yann LeCun did the math on its compressed air.

0.81s	~400 mph	2028
Tesla's claimed 0–60 mph time	Peak speed Musk now floats, versus the 230+ mph Tesla quoted	Production start, in Performance, Thrust and Rocket versions

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on the Roadster

Tesla unveiled the car Thursday night at a SpaceX test site in McGregor, Texas, where Reuters reported it drove upside down on a ramp using suction, flipped and landed on thrusters, and jumped a truck. Aviation Week lists 300-plus miles of range and a one-seat Rocket version "not approved for public road use." Musk kept raising the bar. Tobi Lütke shared a fan simulation claiming a lap 1.8 seconds faster than Max Verstappen and asked, "that can't be right. can it?" Musk answered:

> *"Even without rocket thrusters, Roadster will crush the best Formula 1 track times, because we are using suction and active control surfaces, both of which are banned by F1"*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

He told one poster the car could reach "a peak speed of >0.5 Mach or ~400 mph," promised that "Future fun Roadster demos will include flying over the Snake River or maybe Grand Canyon and landing on its wheels," and told Robert Scoble that owners "will be able to ask the Roadster to perform any of the tricks shown autonomously," with "a wild looping track (crazier even than Hot Wheels) at our Texas HQ." He mused that "Since fate maximizes for ironic entertainment, it was inevitable that the "Roadster" would be a flying car," and reposted a 2008 Jay Leno test drive as "OG Roadster." He was plain about where the value lies:

> *"Optimus and Cybercab will be the vast majority of Tesla's value. The only things that will scale to incredible size (K2 and beyond) economically are super intelligence, robots, solar power and mass to space. And, of course, if you have the first two, the rest will follow. But Roadster is super cool, so we're doing it anyway."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST



A 2008 Tesla Roadster, the original model Musk reposted as "OG Roadster," at AutoRAI Amsterdam in April 2009.

PHOTO: RUTGER VAN DER MAAR · CC BY 2.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Yann LeCun @ylecun · Turing Award laureate

LeCun, who says he owns two Teslas, looked at the thrusters:

> *"Okay, so it's just compressed air. Easier. But crappy specific impulse (less than 50 seconds). Even assuming that 50% of the mass of the car is the compressed air, that gives you less than 10s of useful thrust (with thrust-to-weight ratio larger than 1.0). Probably more like 5 seconds, actually. So the car must be an empty, lightweight shell containing big compressed air tanks. Cute demo, but totally impractical. But of course, you knew that."*
>
> YANN LECUN · @YLECUN · POST

Musk replied at 10:41am EDT Sunday with a Monty Python line, "I fart in your general direction." LeCun answered in kind ("A 700 bar, 600 liter, 3 second, noisy fart") and then with arithmetic: filling 600 liters to 600 bar "takes, in theory, 220 MJoules," or about 110 kWh after compressor losses, "more energy than a full Tesla S battery," and at least 12 hours with current compressors. "All of this for a few seconds of jet boost." He said he exposes "marketing stunts that, while cool on the surface, are not the achievements they are claimed to be," adding that compressed-air thrusters "are not a path to actual flying cars."

Builders on the car Altman · Luckey · Elluswamy · Rauch · Lütke

Sam Altman, Friday: "Wow the new roadster looks quite amazing, good job @elonmusk." Palmer Luckey told a critic who called the thrusters a prop that they "allow for braking and acceleration far in excess of traction limits, cars that use them will dominate lap time records." Tesla AI chief Ashok Elluswamy quoted a "Designed, engineered, and made in America" clip with "By humans"; Musk: "Yes." Guillermo Rauch rebuilt the ramp stunt as a playable browser simulation, then had a DeepSeek model add sound and a chase camera: "I think it cost 30 cents." When The Wall Street Journal wrote that the event showed Musk "has given up designing cars for regular people to drive," Lütke replied that the paper "has given up writing credible accounts of reality for regular people to read," and David Heinemeier Hansson countered that "The Model Y is the world's best selling electric car."

III · LABS AND LAUNCHES

Meta's year-one model, Nvidia's robot skills, Microsoft's weather fix

Alexandr Wang thanked the team behind Muse. Jim Fan open-sourced ASPIRE. Satya Nadella pointed to a Nature paper on forecasts two to six weeks out.

Alexandr Wang @alexandr_wang · Meta Superintelligence Labs

After a week that brought Muse Wonder and Muse Wonder Full (closed weights) and Muse Spark Open (816 billion parameters, 42 billion active, open weights), Wang posted a long note of thanks to Meta Superintelligence Labs (MSL). He recalled setting a goal of a frontier model within a year, "given where llama4 landed," and wrote:

> *"more than just the models we released this week, we have built a machine that builds new models. it often sounds like a cop-out to say labs can just turn the crank to keep scaling, but now i have seen it first-hand. sure, it's a lot of work and a careful process, but we have built a scalable system to keep advancing at the frontier, and i am really proud of how fast this team keeps making these models better."*
>
> ALEXANDR WANG · @ALEXANDR_WANG · POST

He was candid on speed. Quoting an independent VulcanBench run, he called Muse Wonder Full "pretty competitive overall with Astra, Opus 5.5, and Sol 6.1, but definitely slower which is something we're working on."

Jim Fan @DrJimFan · Nvidia GEAR lab

Fan's lab released version 1.0 of ASPIRE (Agentic Skills Discovery for Robotics), with a project page and code on GitHub:

> *"We are open-sourcing V1.0 of our agentic robotics framework, ASPIRE, with full real robot skill discovery and self improvement capabilities! On the day Astra arrived, our lab switched the backend model and saturated all the benchmarks to ~99% over night. And the frontier is already on the move: Opus 5.5 slightly edges out Astra on our robot simulation bench. Sonnet 5.5 hits the Pareto frontier of cost vs. robot capability, $12/task."*
>
> JIM FAN · @DRJIMFAN · POST

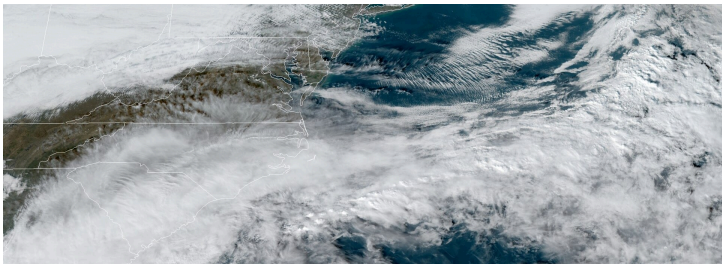
Co-author Guanzhi Wang reported 99% on LIBERO-Pro's 80 tasks and 100% on representative Robosuite and BEHAVIOR-1K tasks; teammate Runyu Lu showed a real arm solving a scrambled Rubik's Cube.

Satya Nadella @satyanadella · CEO, Microsoft

Nadella highlighted Microsoft's Nature paper on subseasonal forecasting and drew a wider point:

> *"There's a broader lesson here... the future may not just be about ever-more-capable models, but about building intelligent verification systems around them: systems that learn where models are systematically wrong, reason about cause and effect, and continuously calibrate predictions against reality."*
>
> SATYA NADELLA · @SATYANADELLA · POST

The method, Probabilistic Bias Correction (PBC), learns a model's habitual errors from its past forecasts and corrects them. Microsoft Research says it improved the leading European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF) model on 98% of precipitation, 92% of temperature and 91% of pressure targets, and doubled the skill of ECMWF's AI forecasting system.



A GOES-East satellite view of a nor'easter forming over the Gulf of Maine on January 2, 2021, the kind of system extended-range forecasts struggle to anticipate.

IMAGE: NOAA/NESDIS · PUBLIC DOMAIN (CROPPED)

More releases Dean · Suleyman · Gebbia

Jeff Dean pointed to Glimpse from Elorian: "Have a glimpse at this! Nice work, @AndrewDai and Elorian folks!" Andrew Dai described it as "our first visual thinking model with competitive frontier performance compared to Astra on key public visual reasoning benchmarks." Mustafa Suleyman said Microsoft AI's MAI-Transcribe-2 is "the most accurate & most popular transcription model on OpenRouter across all languages and use cases." Joe Gebbia's National Design Studio released Rampart Edge, an on-device privacy model, and opened American Forge, a six-month government residency run with Cognition: "Your nation is calling upon the most cracked engineers."

Sam Altman @sama · CEO, OpenAI

Altman posted that "The back of the Navier-Stokes milestone shirt is the last line of the chain-of-thought from the solution," a nod to OpenAI's claimed proof of finite-time blowup, which mathematicians are still checking; New Scientist reported mismatches between its prose and Lean versions. He also cheered former OpenAI researcher Nick Cammarata, who wrote that "the vast majority in models up to trillions of parameters are legible, and their circuits beautiful": "Very happy to see this from Nick!"

> **QUICK HIT**
> **Tobi Lütke** on Odyssey placing a fruit-fly brain inside its Odyssey-3 world model: "Somehow this is incredible and depressing at the same time. The Matrix (1999)"

IV · WHO WRITES THE CODE

Agents write nearly all of it. So why are engineers busier?

François Chollet counted engineers and SaaS revenue. Aaron Levie sees more of the economy turning into software. Tim Sweeney told game developers the typing was always 70% of the job.

François Chollet @fchollet · creator of Keras

> *"Some observations about the "total" automation of software engineering: 1. There are more software engineers now than in 2025, and demand is growing. 2. Software engineers have never worked harder than they do now. 3. They largely don't write code anymore, agents write ~100% of the code. 4. The bottom line of the companies that employs these engineers and agents (i.e. the terminal purpose of all this code) is typically not budging as a result of AI adoption. This is why you have to think in terms of systems. Automating one aspect of a system creates its own friction and moves the bottlenecks elsewhere."*
> FRANÇOIS CHOLLET · @FCHOLLET · POST

Challenged that AI is in fact moving profits, he said he could find no data: "SWE employment at SaaS companies has been flat, and revenue has been 100% tracking long-term trends that predate AI," citing Adobe, Workday, Zoom and Salesforce.

Aaron Levie @levie · CEO, Box

Levie quoted Chollet with the opposite emphasis:

> *"The biggest misread of anyone predicting the end of software engineering was imagining that the world only needed a certain amount of software, and bringing automation to the field would reduce the need for labor. Exactly the opposite is happening where essentially most things are actually turning into software."*
> AARON LEVIE · @LEVIE · POST

He closed: "Yes we're not going to be coding manually in the future. But almost everything will be code." Earlier, reacting to a report that Anthropic's Michael Sellitto told the International Monetary Fund that Claude could lead 80–90% of frontier model training next year, up from 3% in April, Levie wrote "If you aren't pricing in what RSI will lead to, that's probably a mistake," meaning recursive self-improvement (RSI). On Monday he argued that agent swarms make compute "a critical variable in a large number of important tasks in the economy which wasn't possible before."

Tim Sweeney @TimSweeneyEpic · founder and CEO, Epic Games

Sweeney, newly added to the watch list, described building Unreal Engine 1:

> *"When I was writing Unreal Engine 1, my time was divided as follows: Around 30% went to seriously deep coding on hard problems: assembly language texture mappers, C++ BSP trees, data persistence, object oriented systems design, and networking. Around 70% was just typing and refactoring large bodies of code needed for a complete engine feature set... So, it has always seemed perfectly logical that we would rely on AI for that 70%, once the AI could do it with a similar quality standard as we could, which has never been perfection."*
> TIM SWEENEY · @TIMSWEENEYEPIC · POST

The surprise, he wrote, is AI as "a sort of insta-Carmack able to solve hard technical problems quite cleverly," and "What matters is the end product, whether it's a game or an engine." Rauch: "Well said!" When indie asset maker Kenney urged

developers not to let billionaires "convince you slop is the future," Sweeney shot back that he is "the same tech tree following optimist who moved from C to C++, from 2D to 3D, and from closed source to open source." Musk: "Tim Sweeney is right (obviously)." Sweeney later struck a gentler note: "Agreed, the end product is the thing that matters. The velocity of development of it is the force to be reckoned with here." Musk also answered "True" to Sweeney's forecast that games once too costly to make "will soon become possible… It'll be a new golden age of gaming."

Uncle Bob Martin, Yann LeCun, Paul Graham on craft and verification

Uncle Bob Martin: "AI has not trivialized software engineering." On debugging with an agent: "You are the harness. It's a bloodhound. Show it the bug and let it sniff around. Tell it to write tests and instrument the code. It will keep digging until it finds the problem." LeCun on why progress shows up first in two fields: "Math and coding are the two domains where correctness can be checked automatically, without going through real-world experiments or through human evaluations." Paul Graham: "To publish something on a paywalled site is to make it invisible. If AIs can't find it, then for all practical purposes it doesn't exist." Quoting a developer whose systems had been under attack for 48 hours, wrote "This is how things will be for the foreseeable future."

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg · CEO, Vercel

Vercel's fx coding agent became durable across crashes and redeploys: "if a user sends a prompt and then throws their phone into a black hole, we ensure that turn runs to completion."

> **QUICK HIT**
> **Guillermo Rauch** on tech-driven domain booms: "Every once in a while, some unsuspecting country's domain economy goes vertical," listing .ai for Anguilla, .io, .md and, fittingly, .si for Slovenia.

V · COMPUTE AND AGENTS

Renting inference is hard, even for SpaceX

Musk said SpaceX cannot easily rent inference capacity and spent much of the weekend promoting a faster Grok Bot. Vitalik Buterin compared the economics of mining and inference.

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on compute and Grok Bot

Musk posted a clip captioned "What it's like trying to rent AI/SI compute," then explained:

> *"This describes the conversation SpaceX has had when we have tried to rent inference compute from AWS, GCP or anyone at, so that we can shift load off our training clusters!!"*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

He quoted Grok Bot's own update that "Computer tasks finish 3x sooner on average, and replies to everything else arrive in less than half the time," said his team makes "around 20 improvements per day," and said a business "Hagglebot" "could improve enterprise cost-efficiency by 5% or more." Asked how to stop training on personal data, he answered: "Unless you're doing something super unique, your data is not actually useful for training, but we do need some way to debug issues and make the product better." Michael Truell wrote that "Bot is now faster and a bit more delightful," adding that "in the limit, it should be able to handle things in the physical world." Late Sunday Musk offered a caution of his own:

> *"So many people are going to get one-shotted by super persuasive super intelligences and I might be one of them"*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

Vitalik Buterin @VitalikButerin · co-founder, Ethereum

> *"Fun fact of the day: Bitcoin mining cost is split about 50/50 between compute capex and electricity. Meanwhile, AI inference is almost completely dominated by compute capex."*
> VITALIK BUTERIN · @VITALIKBUTERIN · POST

On Ethereum's roadmap, he argued that new cryptography should not live in precompiles or the Ethereum Virtual Machine (EVM), because block data is capped at roughly 8 MB per second: "Remember: it's not a blockchain. It's a cryptographic world computer." His answer is "EIP-8288 maximalism": compute heavy work client-side, prove it with a STARK, and aggregate the proofs, so "we never need to add more precompiles again."

The X platform ads, traffic and bots

At 12:24pm EDT Friday Musk said "all advertising on X will be subject to a reasonable esthetic standard," with advertisers whose ads are "ugly, shrill, strident or overstate claims" barred; The Verge noted no published enforcement criteria. He said X "is seeing all-time high usage" and answered a complaint that reply bots have worsened with "Working on it."

> **QUICK HIT**
> **Elon Musk** on a Tesla patent for locating cars by satellite: "SpaceX Starlink enables precise navigation without the need for GPS satellites."

Wi-Fi on every Southwest jet, and a week in Shenzhen

Southwest set a fleetwide Starlink date. David Heinemeier Hansson found Chinese cars superb and Chinese apps rough.

Starlink and the Musk companies @elonmusk

Musk cheered "Southwest Airlines going all-in with @Starlink!" Aviation Week reports Southwest will equip its entire Boeing 737 fleet by fall 2027, and AirlineGeeks counted 47 jets connected by Oct. 17, with more than 300 targeted by year-end and free Wi-Fi for Rapid Rewards members.



A Southwest Airlines Boeing 737-8 MAX landing at Baltimore-Washington International in August 2026; the airline plans Starlink on its whole 737 fleet by fall 2027.

PHOTO: ACROTERION · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Musk also amplified Starlink kits reaching health centers in Papua New Guinea's Morobe Province. Tesla said supervised Full Self-Driving (FSD) is approved in Slovakia, with rollout soon. On The Boring Company, he credited its president: "Steve Davis and his team deserve almost all the credit for @BoringCompany progress."

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails and Omarchy

Visiting Shenzhen, he rode in a Chinese car whose interior was "as nice or nicer than a top-spec Mercedes S class and the 20-minute drive was $6. Germany should be very worried indeed." The software impressed him less:

> *"As much as I respect Chinese-made AI models and hardware, I'm equally puzzled by how rough most of the software still is. Whether it's Wechat or Alipay or HarmonyOS. You'd think getting unique aesthetics, perfect fidelity, and great flows would be "easy", but clearly it is not."*
>
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · POST

When a reader explained that Chinese apps are designed around dense, two-character labels that break when localized, he conceded he had been viewing them in English and resolved that "the Chinese version of Omarchy doesn't end up looking rough from being designed for English first!" The trip doubled as an Omarchy tour: a Shenzhen meetup, a visit to mini-PC maker Beelink, and a teaser that "To get League of Legends and Valorant onto Omarchy, it'll help to have good friends at Tencent!"

Takeaways

1. Anthropic committed 5% of its shares to a public benefit fund that can grow with valuation; Musk pledged one SpaceX share to every American child next year.
2. Musk promised Formula 1 lap records and canyon jumps for the thruster Roadster; Yann LeCun put a full air recharge near 110 kWh for a few seconds of boost.
3. Meta's Muse models, Nvidia's open-source ASPIRE and Microsoft's Nature weather paper led the lab news.
4. Chollet, Levie and Sweeney agree agents write most code now; they split on what that means for jobs and profits.
5. Musk said SpaceX struggles to rent inference compute, promoted a faster Grok Bot, and set an aesthetic bar for X ads.
6. Southwest plans Starlink across its 737 fleet by fall 2027; 47 jets are connected so far.

On the beat

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Elon Musk, Guillermo Rauch, David Heinemeier Hansson, Yann LeCun, Palmer Luckey, Uncle Bob Martin, Paul Graham, Tim Sweeney, Alexandr Wang, Tobi Lütke, Clément Delangue, Joe Gebbia, Michael Dell, Jim Fan, Vitalik Buterin, François Chollet, Patrick Collison, Sam Altman, Aaron Levie, Michael Truell, Mustafa Suleyman, Marc Andreessen, Fei-Fei Li, Ashok Elluswamy, Satya Nadella, Jeff Dean.

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Jensen Huang, Andrej Karpathy, Demis Hassabis, Dario Amodei, John Carmack, Andrew Ng, Greg Brockman, Tom Brown, Mira Murati, Mark Zuckerberg, Noam Brown, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Lisa Su, Sundar Pichai, Kanjun Qiu, Nat Friedman, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample, Mark Chen.

Added Tim Sweeney (@TimSweeneyEpic), founder and CEO of Epic Games. The list now stands at 46.

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